

Port Operations

Port Management - Giving a Presentation

Exercise 1

Ok, ladies and gentlemen, just before we set off on our tour of the Port I just wanted to take a couple of minutes to say a few words about the style of port management today. Now, **<how many of you have>** hands-on experience of port management? Ok, that's quite a number of you then. So you'll be able to relate to what I'm saying.

<So, to begin, let's look more closely at> ports. Well, traditionally these have been run like government departments, but now they're becoming a normal industry thanks to the infusion of private money. This brings a) greater competition, **** higher productivity and **<c>** eventually lower costs that will be passed on to importers and exporters. **<And what's the result?>** Yes, a public sector that has been forced to reassess its role in the port industry.

<As you are aware>, governments have retreated from port management in the firm belief that an enterprise-based economy allows for greater flexibility and efficiency in the market and a more effective response to consumers' demands. Many so-called port privatisation schemes are in fact some form of commercialisation or corporatisation of a port authority

<Right, now, let's turn to> corporatisation itself: **<I hear you saying>**, what exactly is corporatisation? **<Well>**, corporatisation basically amounts to a shift from public sector organisations to autonomous companies. These are owned by the public sector but have accounting procedures and legal requirements similar to the private sector. In the case of commercialisation the government retains control and ownership of the port organisation, but within a business-like environment involving some management autonomy and accountability. **<OK, are you with me so far?>**

<Let's move on, then, to> the private sector: This sector undertakes many commercial activities through performance agreements, management contracts, service contracts, lease systems and/or concession agreements with the public port organisation. Mainland Europe has followed the path of public sector retreat via corporatisation and commercialisation, as most governments have loosened their grip on ports. **<We shouldn't forget, however, that>** port authorities still have robust ties with their respective municipalities through ownership structure.

<I'd just like to finish by saying that> the final aim is the creation of an independent port management system with a sound commercial strategy. I hope we can show you some of that strategy today. **<Thank you>** and enjoy the rest of your visit to the Port of Antwerp.

Exercise 2

1. The final aim is the creation of an independent port management system with a sound commercial strategy
2. Decisions are made on a more independent basis and port managers are accountable for these decisions.
3. Most governments have loosened their grip on ports.
4. Port authorities still have robust ties with their respective municipalities through ownership structure
5. Mainland Europe has followed the path of public sector retreat via corporatisation and commercialisation

Exercise 3

1. robust <weak>
2. effective <ineffective>
3. similar <dissimilar>
4. independent <dependent>
5. loosened <tighten>
6. limited <unlimited>
7. retreat <advance>
8. volatile <stable>

Port of Antwerp sees cargo volume grow once more by nearly 6 %

(Listening Comprehension)

Exercise 1

- 1) In the first <nine> months of 2005 the port of Antwerp handled nearly <120 million tonnes> of cargo, an increase of <5.7 per cent> compared with the same period last year.
- 2) The container volume between January and September amounted to <55.8 million tonnes>, up <8.6 per cent> on the previous year.

- 3) In terms of twenty-foot equivalent units (TEU) this represents an increase of **<5.8 per cent>**, to **<4.8 million TEU>**.
- 4) In the third quarter the volume of containers handled was up on the same period in 2004 by **<11 per cent>** in TEU and **<14 per cent>** in tonnes.
- 5) Ro/ro cargo for its part contracted slightly during the past **<nine>** months, by **<4 per cent.>**
- 6) **<589,413>** cars, trucks and trailers have been shipped through the port of Antwerp so far this year.
- 7) Imports remain stable, and the decline in exports has been reduced during the past quarter from **<20 to 15 per cent>**.
- 8) Conventional general cargo expanded by **<3 per cent>** in the first three quarters of this year, reaching **<13.6 million tonnes>**.
- 9) Imports in particular have risen significantly as a result of the strong increase in steel products (**<up 23 per cent>**).
- 10) The volume of bulk freight handled in Antwerp stood at **<47.8 million tonnes>** at the end of the third quarter, an increase of nearly **<4 per cent>**. Both imports and exports were up during the past nine months.
- 11) There were particularly strong increases in the volume of chemicals (**<up 11 per cent>**) and oil derivatives (**<up 14 per cent>**).
- 12) From January to September a total of **<11,407>** seagoing vessels called at the port of Antwerp. This represents a further slight decrease of **<1.7 per cent>** in comparison with the first nine months of last year. On the other hand, the gross register tonnage continues to trend upwards, with growth of more than **<3.7 per cent>**.

Exercise 2

Upward trend	Stability	Downward trend
<an increase of 5.7 per cent>	<remain stable>	<contracted slightly>
<imports and exports up by>		<drop in exports>
<up 8.6 per cent on>		
<up on the same period in 2004 by>		
<decline in exports has been reduced>		

Exercise 3

Upward trend	Stability	Downward trend
<expanded by>	<now levelling off>	<a further slight decrease of>
<risen significantly>	<remain stable>	
<strong increase>		
<an increase of>		
<were up>		
<particularly strong increases>		
<continues to trend upwards>		
<growth of more than >		

Port organisation in the Port of Antwerp (Reading Comprehension)

Exercise 1

Ten years ago, The Antwerp Port Authority **<owned>** the docks and the sites used by port operators and industrial companies on the Right Bank of the Scheldt. It **<was>** also the owner of part of the port equipment.

The Port Authority also **<managed>** the Left Bank port, which **<ensured>** the application of uniform policies on both sides of the river. However, land use and industrial development policy on the Left Bank **<was in the hands of>** a separate public sector corporation for land use and industrialisation.

The private port companies had **<to make>** the necessary investments in superstructure and handling equipment on the bare facilities they **<leased>** **<were leasing>**¹ from the Port Authority. At that time, private enterprise **<was>** also responsible for all logistic and transport services to the port users.

¹ accept both alternatives

The Port of Antwerp, public sector partnership (Listening Comprehension)

Exercise 1

All kinds of public services are involved in the activities of the port. The Antwerp Port Authority, with a workforce of 1,900, owns and manages docks, berths, locks, etc. It is responsible for (to plan) planning, (to expand) expanding, (to modernise) modernising and (to maintain) maintaining the infrastructure of the port, and also operates its own equipment, including warehouses, floating cranes, shore cranes, tugs and dredgers.

Exercise 2

1. What do you notice about the verb that immediately follows “to be responsible for”?

- a) It is always followed by the infinitive
- b) It is always followed by the gerund (-ing form).**
- c) It is always followed by the present
- d) It is always followed by the future

2. What do you notice about the verbs that immediately follow the phrases “to play an important part in” and “to be employed in”?

- a) They are always followed by the gerund (-ing form).**
- a) They are always followed by the infinitive
- c) They are always followed by the present
- d) It is always followed by the future

3. Which is the odd one out?

- a) To be interested in
- b) To enjoy
- c) To intend to**
- d) To plan on

4. Why is “to intend to” the odd one out?

- a) It is always followed by the infinitive. The others are always followed by the gerund.**
- b) It is always followed by the gerund. The others are always followed by the infinitive.
- c) It is always followed by the present. The others are always followed by the infinitive.
- d) It is always followed by the future. The others are always followed by the gerund.

The Port of Antwerp, private sector partnership (Reading Comprehension)

Exercise 1

<i>The Antwerp Shipping Federation (ASV)</i>	<represents the agents and shipowners' offices who watch over the interests of the 300 or so shipowners whose ships make regular use of the port>.
The 100-odd members of the ASV	<include shipbrokers and operators>.
<i>The Belgian Shipowners' Association (BRV)</i>	<represents shipowners who are involved in the carriage of gas, bulk cargoes and oil.>
<i>Antwerp Freight Forwarding, Logistics and Works' Agents Association (VEA)</i>	<represents the interests of the 210 forwarders and industrial shipping agents in Antwerp>.
ABAS and the KVBG	<Represent Antwerp's cargo handlers>.
The majority of ABAS' 30-odd members	<are stevedores, although both warehousing specialists and companies performing related activities such as lashing and securing also belong to the association>.
The sixty members of the KVBG	<take care of the handling, warehousing and distribution of goods>.
ALFAPORT ANTWERPEN	<acts as the representative of business in the port and promotes the interests of port users in many different areas>.
CEPA or the <i>Port of Antwerp Employers' Association</i> and the <i>Employers' Association of Trade and Shipping Offices</i>	<are both involved in the social sector>.
INPRO, the <i>Dangerous Products Information Centre</i>	<is a helpdesk for firms seeking information about dangerous goods>.

A multipurpose port (Listening Comprehension)

Exercise 1

- 1) The Port of Antwerp handles
- a) more than 15 million tonnes of cargo per year
 - b) more than 50 million tonnes of cargo per year
 - c) more than 115 million tonnes of cargo per year
 - d) more than 150 million tonnes of cargo per year**

- 2) The Port of Antwerp handles
- a) 55% outgoing, 45% incoming traffic
 - b) 55% incoming, 45% outgoing traffic**
 - c) 35% incoming, 65% outgoing traffic
 - d) 35% outgoing, 65% incoming traffic
- 3) Antwerp is, by volume,
- a) the fourth largest port in the world**
 - b) the third largest port in the world
 - c) the third largest port in Europe
 - d) the fourth largest port in Europe
- 4) Examples of bulk given are
- a) coal, ore, fertiliser, grain
 - b) coals, ore, fertiliser, grains
 - c) coal, ores, fertilisers, grain**
 - d) coals, ores, fertilisers, grains
- 5) The Port of Antwerp has specialised handling installations for
- a) fruit, forest products, cars, dangerous goods and sugar
 - b) iron, fruit, cars and dangerous goods
 - c) iron and steel, fruit, forest products, cars, dangerous goods and sugar**
 - d) iron and steel, forest products, dangerous goods and sugar

Exercise 2

- 1 It comes as no surprise that Antwerp is
- a) a marked leader in many of these trades
 - b) a market leader in many of these trades**
 - c) a marked leader in many of these traits
 - d) a market leader in many of these traits
2. Antwerp has
- a) responded positively to the unitised load phenomenon**
 - b) retained positive to the unitised load phenomenon
 - c) responded positive to the unitised load phenomenon
 - d) remained positive to the unitised load phenomenon
3. Nowadays ____ of all general cargo is packed in containers.
- a) 76%**
 - b) 67%
 - c) 7.6%
 - d) 6.7%

4. Antwerp's container terminals pride themselves on

- a) their productivity and location
- b) their prosperity and location
- c) their prosperity and low costs
- d) their productivity and low costs**

5. Antwerp offers the best

- a) quality to price ration of all north seaports
- b) quality to prize ratio of all North Sea ports
- c) quality to price ratio of all North Sea ports.**
- d) quality to price ratio of all Northsea Ports

Isolation and Communication (Listening Comprehension interview)

Exercise 1

1. What does John Attenborough do?

- a) He is a priest
- b) He is a Port Chaplain.**
- c) He is a captain
- d) He is a chargehand

2. How does he describe the Left Bank?

- a) a ghost town**
- b) a great town
- c) a coastal town
- d) a growing town

3. What, according to him, is one of the biggest challenges facing seafarers?

- a) consolation
- b) relationships
- c) elation
- d) isolation**

4. Look at the picture below



Why did the seafarer not want his photograph taken?

- a) He wanted to remain anonymous
- b) He was thinking of his family back home
- c) He was wondering how to get ashore
- d) **He was not in a happy mood**

5. What problem did John face when he tried to gain access to a ship recently?

- a) he was refused access because the cargo was of a sensitive nature
- b) the captain would not let him on board because the cargo was of a sensitive nature
- c) **the security guard eventually allowed him access even though the goods were of a sensitive nature**
- d) the security guard followed him on board because the goods were of a sensitive nature

6. When was the Deurganckx Dock opened?

- a) **June 6th**
- b) June 16th
- c) July 6th
- d) July 16th

7. What have the two companies managing the dock agreed to do?

- a) Provide accommodation for seafarers
- b) Provide a bus into town for seafarers
- c) **Provide welfare facilities for seafarers**
- d) Provide telephone boxes for seafarers

8. According to John, it is exciting to see that

- a) seafarers may have somewhere relatively accessible where they feel welcome
- b) **seafarers will have somewhere relatively accessible where they feel welcome**
- c) seafarers might have somewhere relatively accessible where they feel welcome
- d) seafarers won't have somewhere relatively accessible where they feel welcome

Exercise 2

The Port of Antwerp has a large <ecumenical> team which is responsible for the welfare of all seafarers. So far this year, Port Chaplain John Attenborough has been busy visiting the ships that have come into the Port of Antwerp. He has concentrated his efforts on the <Left Bank> as this area is so far away from most amenities, which are located on the <Left Bank> of the river Scheldt.

Stephanie Hughes spoke to him.

- John, please tell me something about your work on the Left Bank.

- Well Stephanie, during the weekends the whole area is like a ghost town, no lorries, no cars, not much of anything. Isolation is one of the biggest challenges that seafarers face in the modern shipping world. The seafarers are very lucky if they can even manage to find a telephone in order to call their loved ones back home. This is something that many people fail to understand in this modern world of mobile phones. Seafarers have a harder time than most of the population, because the roaming service on a mobile is extortionately expensive. One seafarer told me that being on a ship on the Left Bank was like being in a desert. He went on to say, "All you need is some sand and the picture would be complete!" He did not want me to take his photo, because he was not in a happy mood.

- Can you tell me something about the challenges you face when visiting the ships?"

- Though ships are getting bigger and faster, crewing levels are decreasing. With new security regulations, seafarers find it more difficult to leave the ship and chaplains and welfare workers find it more difficult to gain access to the ships and to the seafarers on board. On one occasion, I encountered a security guard who refused me access to one ship on the grounds that the cargo was of a sensitive nature. I said that I had nothing to do with the cargo, all I wanted to do was to go and talk to the crew. After some time, the security guard finally agreed to let me on board. The crew were so grateful for my visit. It seems obvious that the nature of the cargo should not get in the way of welfare of the crew, but more often than not it seems the cargo is valued more highly than the welfare of the seafarers.

Exercise 3

- But is there any good news on the horizon?

- There certainly is. For the new Deurganck Dock, officially opened on June 6th 2006, there is provision in the agreement by the companies running the new dock, HN-PSA and P&O Ports, to provide welfare facilities to the seafarers that come in on the ships which berth in the dock.

- So it is just a case of waiting and seeing.

- Yes, It will be interesting to see how the new facilities make a difference to the lives of the seafarers visiting Antwerp. I was recently invited to a meeting with one of the companies running the new dock and am pleased to report that the needs of the seafarers have been taken into consideration. The companies have agreed to provide telephones, computers, a TV, a comfortable seating area and some shelving on which we can put newspapers and magazines for

the seafarers to take. The ships using the new dock will only be <container vessels>, so the time in port will be a matter of <hours>. It is really exciting to see that, at last, seafarers will have somewhere relatively accessible where they feel welcome.

- Thank you for your time and for the useful insights into the developments in the Port of Antwerp.

- You're welcome.

Exercise 4

1. <The> Port of Antwerp has <a> large ecumenical team which is responsible for <the> welfare of all <-> seafarers.
2. During <the OR -> weekends the whole area is like <a> ghost town, no lorries, no cars, not much of anything.
3. Isolation is one of <the> biggest challenges that <-> seafarers face in <the> modern shipping world.
4. <->Seafarers have a harder time than most of <the> population, because <the> roaming service on <a> mobile is extortionately expensive.
5. On one occasion, I encountered <a> security guard who refused me access to one ship on <the> grounds that <the> cargo was of <a> sensitive nature.
6. For <the> new Deurganck Dock, officially opened on <-> June 6th, there is <-> provision in <the> agreement by <the> companies running <the> new dock, HN-PSA and P&O Ports, to provide <-> welfare facilities to <the> seafarers that come in on <the> ships which berth in <the> dock.
7. I was recently invited to <a> meeting with one of <the> companies running <the> new dock and am pleased to report that <the> needs of <the OR - > seafarers have been taken into consideration.
8. <The> ships using <the> new dock will be <->container vessels so <the> time in <- OR the> port will be <a> matter of hours. It is really exciting to see that, at last, <-> seafarers will have somewhere relatively accessible where they feel welcome.